

CourtPath PRD

Product purpose

CourtPath is a trust-centered court navigation and legal-workflow platform that helps people and organizations organize court-related matters, understand next steps, prepare documents, track deadlines, and escalate to human help when needed.[cite:333][cite:342] A product requirements document should define the product purpose, key features, user needs, and success criteria so the team has a shared source of truth during development.[cite:333]

Product goals

- Reduce confusion during court-related workflows.
- Help users move from a stressful situation to an organized matter workspace.
- Improve filing readiness and deadline awareness.
- Support both public users and professional or partner users.
- Preserve trust through clear boundaries, source visibility, and escalation paths.

These goals reflect the role of a PRD as a guide to product behavior, functionality, and delivery alignment.[cite:333][cite:339]

User segments

- Self-represented individuals.
- Families managing disputes or filings.
- Small business owners handling court-related matters.
- Nonprofit and legal-aid intake teams.
- Professional support users and administrators.

User-centered requirements should be linked to user stories so features stay tied to real workflows instead of abstract functionality.[cite:333][cite:342]

Core modules

1. Guided intake.
2. Matter dashboard.
3. Timeline and event log.
4. Document vault.
5. Filing-readiness workflow.
6. Alerts and next-step engine.
7. Referral and human-help routing.

8. Admin and partner workspace.

User stories and acceptance criteria

Module 1 — Guided intake

User story: As a public user, the user wants to describe a court-related problem in plain language so the platform can organize the situation into a workable matter.[cite:342][cite:337]

Acceptance criteria:

- Given a new user starts intake, when they answer guided questions, then the system creates a matter record with category, status, urgency, and next-step recommendations.[cite:337][cite:336]
- Given required intake questions are incomplete, when the user tries to continue, then the system shows clear validation messages.[cite:337]
- Given the user exits intake, when they return later, then the system reopens their in-progress matter draft within the current session.[cite:333]

Module 2 — Matter dashboard

User story: As a user, the user wants one central matter dashboard so documents, deadlines, tasks, and status are visible in one place.[cite:342]

Acceptance criteria:

- Given a matter exists, when the dashboard loads, then it displays matter title, urgency, task progress, upcoming deadlines, and recent activity.[cite:333][cite:337]
- Given there are no uploaded documents yet, when the dashboard loads, then the user sees an empty state with a clear next action.[cite:333]

Module 3 — Timeline and event log

User story: As a user, the user wants to build a timeline of events so the matter history is easier to understand and communicate.[cite:342]

Acceptance criteria:

- Given the user adds an event, when they save it, then the event appears in chronological order on the matter timeline.[cite:337]
- Given an event is edited, when the changes are saved, then the updated event replaces the prior version in the timeline display.[cite:337]

Module 4 — Document vault

User story: As a user, the user wants to store matter-related files in one place so paperwork is easier to find and organize.[cite:342]

Acceptance criteria:

- Given a user uploads a supported file, when the upload succeeds, then the document is attached to the matter and visible in the vault.[cite:333]
- Given a user views documents, when filters are applied, then the list updates by type, status, or date.[cite:333]

Module 5 — Filing-readiness workflow

User story: As a user, the user wants a filing-readiness checklist so they can see what is missing before trying to submit paperwork.[cite:342][cite:333]

Acceptance criteria:

- Given the matter has required filing steps, when the filing module opens, then the user sees completed, incomplete, and blocked items.[cite:337]
- Given a required step is missing, when the user attempts to mark the matter ready, then the system blocks completion and explains what remains.[cite:336][cite:337]

Module 6 — Alerts and next-step engine

User story: As a user, the user wants reminders and priority guidance so they do not miss deadlines or important actions.[cite:342]

Acceptance criteria:

- Given a deadline exists, when it approaches a configured threshold, then the system marks it as upcoming and highlights it in the dashboard.[cite:333]
- Given a matter has unresolved blockers, when the user returns to the workspace, then the next-step panel prioritizes the most important action.[cite:333]

Module 7 — Referral and human-help routing

User story: As a user, the user wants to know when human help is recommended so they can escalate before making a serious mistake.[cite:342]

Acceptance criteria:

- Given the matter matches a high-risk rule, when the system evaluates the matter, then it shows a recommendation to seek human help.[cite:337]
- Given referral options are available, when the user opens support options, then the platform shows available pathways by matter type and urgency.[cite:333]

Module 8 — Admin and partner workspace

User story: As a partner or admin user, the user wants to review matters and support users through a structured queue so help can be delivered consistently.[cite:342]

Acceptance criteria:

- Given a partner user logs in, when they open their workspace, then they see assigned matters, priority flags, and recent updates.[cite:333]
- Given permissions differ by role, when a user opens restricted areas, then only authorized actions are available.[cite:333]

Nonfunctional requirements

- Accessible, mobile-friendly interface.
- Clear loading, empty, success, and error states.
- Secure document handling and permission boundaries.
- Auditability of key actions and matter updates.
- Clear product language for the general public.

A PRD should include product behavior and constraints, not only feature wishes, so engineering can treat it as a real implementation guide.[cite:333][cite:339]

Success metrics

- Intake completion rate.
- Matter creation rate.
- Filing-readiness completion rate.
- Deadline engagement rate.
- Referral click-through rate.
- Pilot activation and partner usage.

Release sequence

- MVP: intake, dashboard, timeline, document vault, filing-readiness basics, alerts.
- Pilot: partner workspace, referral logic, deeper workflows, analytics.
- Expansion: multi-jurisdiction support, advanced document automation, richer integrations.

Notes for design and engineering

The PRD should stay linked to wireframes, design exploration, and user stories so implementation stays aligned as the product evolves.[cite:333][cite:339] Acceptance criteria should be treated as pass/fail conditions for feature completion, whether they are written in simple checklist form or given/when/then format.[cite:337][cite:344]

